

Lord and Behold

On Janmashtami, the NCP in Maharashtra came up with a rather novel entertainment idea—Ukrainian belly dancers. While Krishna's penchant for village belles is well-known, a performance by Ukrainian beauties at an NCP-funded programme kicked up a minor storm, given that Finance Minister Jayant Patil was in the audience. While the moral policeman, Deputy Chief Minister R.R. Patil, has a huge problem with bar girls, he seems to be fine with these dancers. But the BJP has demanded an apology from NCP leaders for introducing sleaze to a sacred festival. Wonder what the belly dancers have to say.



SALSA SIZZLER

When all else fails, turn to item numbers. After a box-office turkey like *Neil 'N' Nikki* and bit roles in *Sarkar* and *Sarkar Raj*, Tanisha Mukherjee is trying to get all eyes on herself by shimmying in her first item number. The actor will do a salsa number in director Kabir Sadanand's *Turn Milo To Sahi* that stars Suniel Shetty and *Chak De* goalie Vidya Malavade. The song has been choreographed by Danny, Savio and Kunjan. Will her dance moves do what her acting couldn't?



FOTOGIMP

In Her Bag

The bag conscious brigade already swears by Meera Mahadevia's fancy clutches, rooted in rich Indian arts. Now, this bag lady is the first Indian accessory designer to have been invited to participate in Pret-a-Porter Paris, The Box, a trade event held in September. "I had a chance meeting with the people concerned in Paris and showed them three of my clutches," says Mahadevia, who's taking about 100 pieces to the show. After 22 years in the business, this designer is bagging it all.



DARKER SHADES

Breaking away from her holier-than-thou bahu image, **Shweta Tiwari** is getting mean—on screen, of course. The actor, who has been in the news for her troubled marriage with actor-producer Raja Chowdhary, will be seen in her new show *Ajeeb*, where she plays a superstar who wants revenge from her billionaire boyfriend. "She is unlike any vamp. She plays a patient dressed in a plain gown without make-up or costume," says producer Bonnie Jain. Will the negative Tiwari get positive reviews? Stay tuned.



Here's something you'd
be happy to hear!
The crunchiest potato chips. Bingo!

